Digital Literacy

Project Report

By : Srestha Gupta

Registration no. 25BOE10126

Project Overview: Digital Literacy

As a Student Digital Ambassador, the goal of this project is to build a comprehensive digital portfolio that demonstrates proficiency in modern online tools and responsible digital citizenship. The project is divided into five core modules:

1. **Visual Communication:** Creating a digital literacy infographic.
2. **Professional Presence:** Setting up foundational profiles on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn.
3. **Technical & Collaborative Skills:** Completing coding challenges and building collaborative Google Forms.
4. **Professional Communication:** Mastering email etiquette and social media responsibility.
5. **Digital Safety:** Researching cybercrime and developing prevention strategies.

All deliverables are organized within a single GitHub repository, serving as a permanent digital asset for academic and professional growth.

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Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I created a one-page visual infographic aimed at educating my peers on the core components of digital literacy. I utilized **Canva** to design the resource, selecting a template that allowed for a clean, professional layout. The infographic covers three vital topics: an overview of what digital literacy entails, a list of essential digital tools for engineering students (such as GitHub and Miro), and a section dedicated to safe internet practices like two-factor authentication.

The design process was highly insightful; I focused on using icons and brief bullet points to ensure the information was digestible for a busy student audience. One thing I found particularly interesting was the "colour psychology" involved in making an educational resource—choosing professional blues and whites to convey trust. The most difficult aspect was condensing complex information about "safe internet practices" into just a few impactful sentences without losing the necessary depth. This task reinforced the idea that as a Digital Ambassador, visual communication is just as important as the information itself.

Task 2 Write-up: Building Student Digital Portfolio

In this module, I established my professional digital foundation by setting up accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. These platforms were chosen because they represent the "big three" for a student in a technical branch: GitHub for version control and project hosting, LinkedIn for professional networking and career updates, and Kaggle for data science and machine learning practice

On GitHub, I created a profile README that introduces myself, my branch, and my primary learning goals for the next four years. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my current degree at VIT Bhopal. Over the next four years, I plan to use LinkedIn to connect with alumni and industry experts, while my GitHub will serve as a living repository of my coding projects and academic growth. Kaggle will be my primary site for entering competitions to hone my analytical skills. Setting these up early ensures that by the time I reach my final year, I will have a robust, four-year-old digital history that demonstrates consistency to potential employers

Task 3 Write-up: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Task 3 focused on the practical application of coding and collaboration tools. For the coding portion, I used HackerRank to complete the "Solve Me First" and "Python Introduction" challenges. These exercises helped me familiarize myself with the competitive coding environment, which is crucial for technical interviews. For the collaboration portion, I designed a 5-question Google Form titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz". The form includes multiple-choice questions regarding password security and a short-answer section for peer feedback.

These tools will be immensely helpful academically. HackerRank provides a structured path for mastering programming languages, while Google Workspace tools like Forms and Sheets are essential for team projects and data collection during lab assignments. Practicing with these platforms now reduces the learning curve for future group work. As a Digital Ambassador, being proficient in these tools allows me to assist batchmates who may struggle with setting up their first repository or organizing survey data for their own projects.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

This task involved drafting professional emails and creating a social media etiquette guide. I practiced writing a formal request for an assignment extension and a cold email to an internship coordinator. Both drafts focused on clarity, professional salutations, and concise body paragraphs.

The scenario I explored regarding poor communication involved a student who lost an internship opportunity because their initial email was too casual and lacked a subject line. This highlighted the key learning that digital communication is a direct reflection of one's professionalism. From this, I learned that a well-structured email with a clear "ask" and a respectful tone is often the difference between a reply and being ignored. These skills are vital for any Digital Ambassador helping peers transition from casual social media habits to professional academic standards.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

Researching Phishing and UPI fraud for this module was eye-opening. What surprised me most was the sophistication of modern social engineering; attackers often use "fear of missing out" or urgent bank alerts to trick even tech-savvy students. I realized that most cybercrimes succeed not through technical hacks, but through human error.

As a result, one habit I will personally change is the way I handle "official" links in SMS or emails; I will now always go directly to the official app or website instead of clicking provided links. Additionally, I am now more aware of the importance of reporting incidents through the **National Cyber Crime Portal (1930)**. This task has given me the confidence to advise my peers on securing their financial transactions and recognizing the subtle red flags of online scams

Conclusion

Completing this project has significantly broadened my understanding of what it means to be "digitally literate". It is more than just knowing how to use a computer; it is about professional branding, efficient collaboration, and maintaining a high standard of safety and ethics online. By building this portfolio on GitHub, I have not only met the course requirements but also created a foundation for my future career. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I feel prepared to guide others in navigating these essential tools responsibility.